



Maria Valentino

Microsoft Copilot Basics

This course covers the basics of using Microsoft Copilot at Gannett. It focuses on access, definitions/screens and prompts.



Goals

OVERVIEW



What's the 411 on Microsoft Copilot?



Why Microsoft Copilot?



One Copilot: Several Hats



Let's Take a Tour: Main Copilot Screen



Let's Take Another Tour (not 3 hour!): Microsoft Copilot within Applications



Prompt Prowess: Basics of Prompts

 Prompt Prowess: Let's See it Live!

 Prompt Prowess: Best Practices

 Check Yourself! Knowledge Check

 Tell Me More: References

Goals



This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under CC BY-SA

In this course, we will cover these topics:

- What is Microsoft Copilot?
- What are the benefits of Microsoft Copilot over the competition?
- What are the differences between the web version and the full licensed version?
- The basics of the Microsoft Copilot screen
- The basics of working with Copilot in other Microsoft applications
- The basics of prompts along with examples
- References/Resources for further study

CONTINUE

What's the 411 on Microsoft Copilot?



Let's Talk about Microsoft Copilot



What is Microsoft Copilot?

To obtain a good definition of Microsoft Copilot, I went right to the source. I asked it to introduce itself. How much more meta can we get?!

Here's how Microsoft Copilot introduced itself:



"Hi there! I'm **Microsoft Copilot**, your AI-powered assistant built right into the Microsoft 365 apps you already use—like Word, Excel, Outlook, and Teams. Think of me as your helpful teammate who is always ready to jump in.

You don't need to be technical to use me—just type or say what you need in plain language and I'll take care of the rest. Whether you're training a team, preparing a guide or just trying to save time, I'm here to help you work smarter, not harder."

CONTINUE

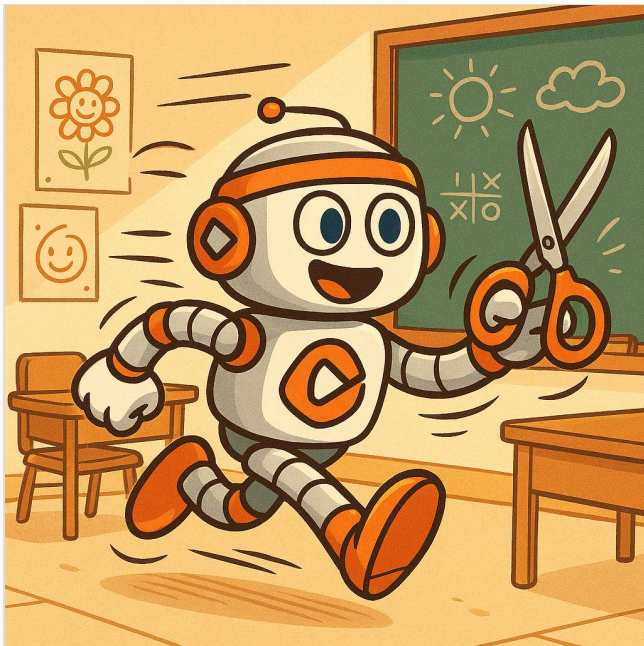
Why Microsoft Copilot?



Why Did Gannett Chose Microsoft Copilot?

We know there are a lot of other AI tools out there. Shhhh...we won't mention their names!

Flip the cards below to learn more about the specific benefits of Microsoft Copilot. In other words, find out why Gannett "flipped" over this AI choice!



Enterprise Grade Security and Privacy

Copilot respects Microsoft's **Data Loss Prevention (DLP)** policies. It ensures:

- Prompts and responses are **not used to train AI models**



Natural Language Search (NLS)

While NLS sounds all "techie," it actually means the opposite!

Traditional search engines (such as Google, Bing, etc.),



Integration with Microsoft Tools

Microsoft Copilot is tightly integrated with all the familiar Microsoft tools we already use at Gannett. Tools such as:

- Word

CONTINUE

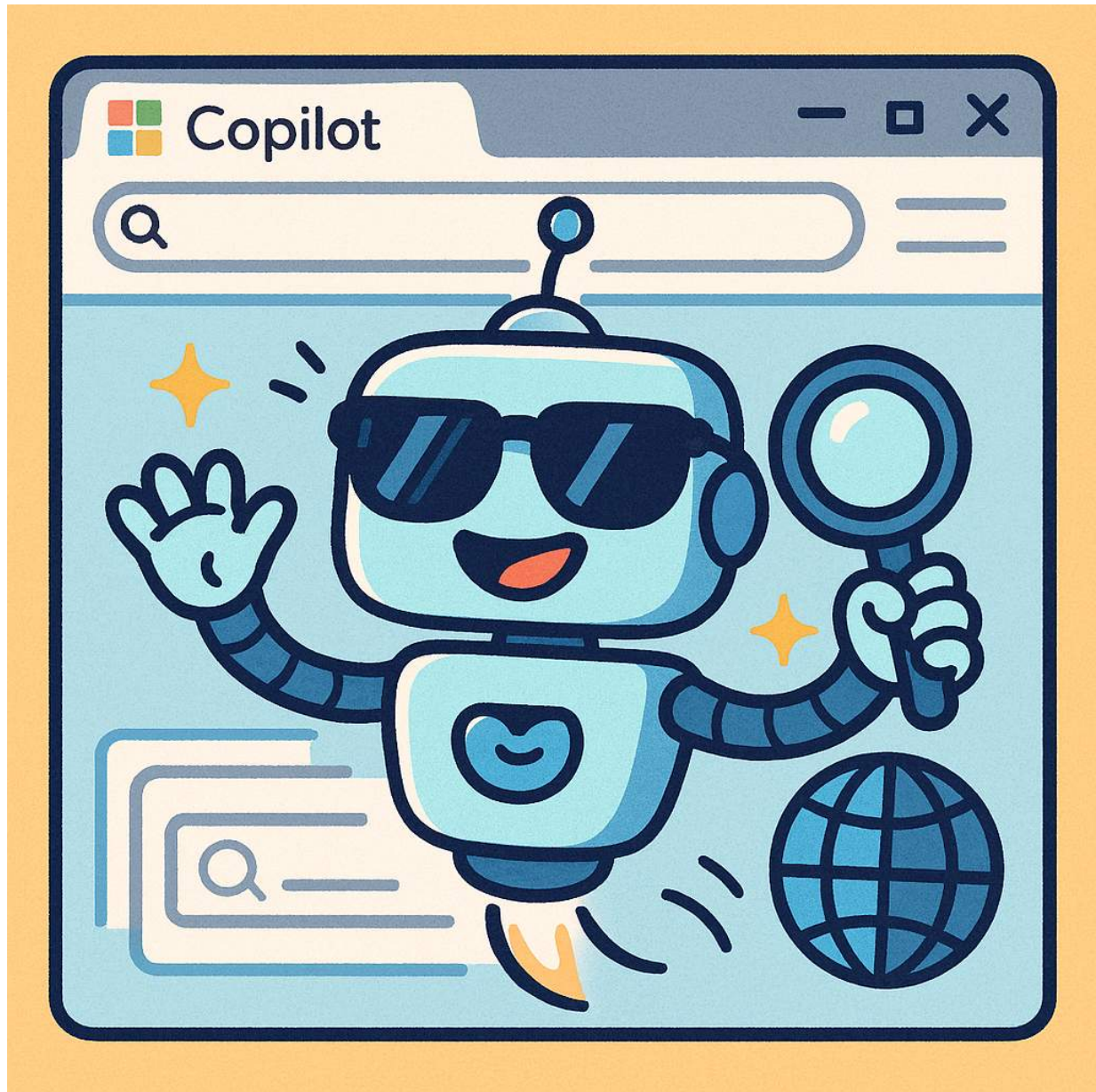
Lesson 4 of 11

One Copilot: Several Hats



Which Hat is Your Copilot Wearing?

There are several flavors of Microsoft Copilot currently available at Gannett.



Web Version

This is the basic version of Microsoft Copilot access. It is available to anyone with Microsoft 365 access. It acts like other AI tools, utilizing the web to obtain results.

Full Licensed Version

This version includes tight integration within our Microsoft applications. It also provides the ability to conduct searches within our work enterprise, searching across outlook emails, SharePoint files, etc.

Who hasn't spent an hour searching and saying to yourself, "I know there was some email about that meeting...or was it a Teams message? When was it? June? No wait, August?" Copilot can help!

To request access to the full licensed version, submit a Service Desk ticket here:

[Service Desk Microsoft Copilot License Request](#)



CONTINUE

Let's Take a Tour: Main Copilot Screen



Maria Valentino

Accessing the Main Copilot Screen

Let's look at the steps for accessing the main Microsoft Copilot screen.

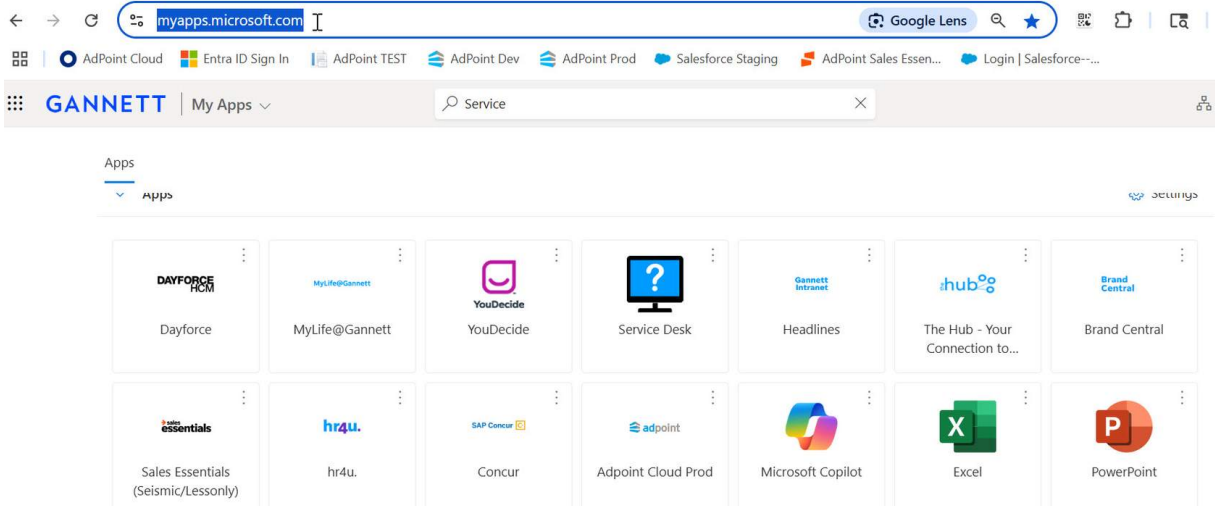
Where's Copilot?



Follow these steps to access Microsoft Copilot directly.

Step 1

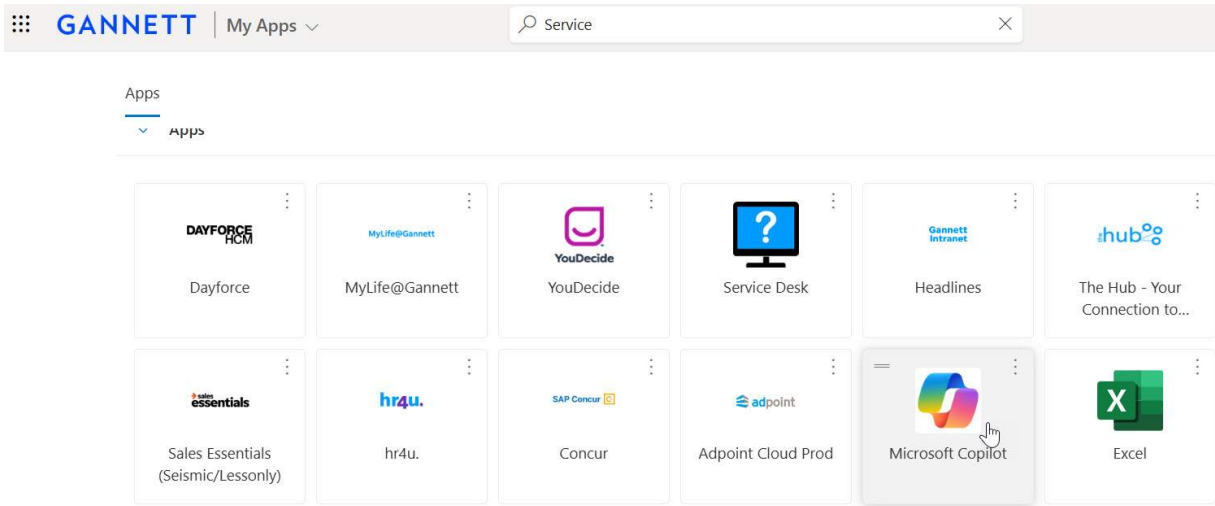
My Apps



Go to your My Apps link at <https://myapps.microsoft.com/>.

Step 2

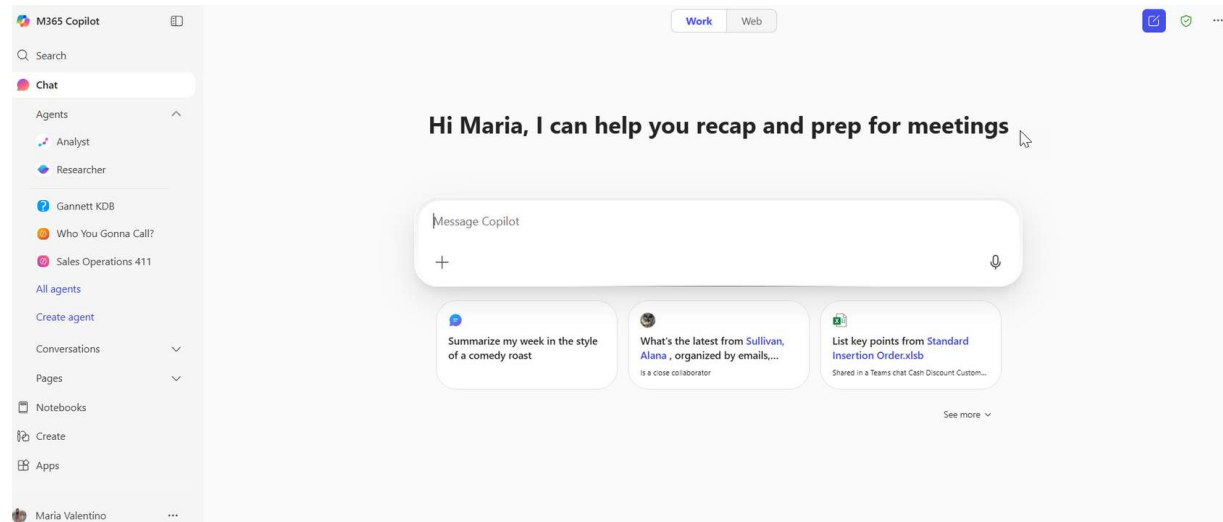
Click on the Microsoft Copilot "Chiclet"



Click on the Microsoft Copilot chiclet. If you are missing this chiclet, see the References section of this training class for details on how to request it.

Step 3

Main Microsoft Copilot Screen



You will be taken to the main Microsoft Copilot screen. Your screen will look slightly different depending on what type of access you have. See more details in the next section.

Success!



Following these steps should take you to the main Microsoft Copilot screen. Enjoy!

Speaking the Language: Key Microsoft Copilot Terms

In order to understand some of the items on the Microsoft Copilot main screen, let's define some terms. Click on the words below to learn more!

Prompt

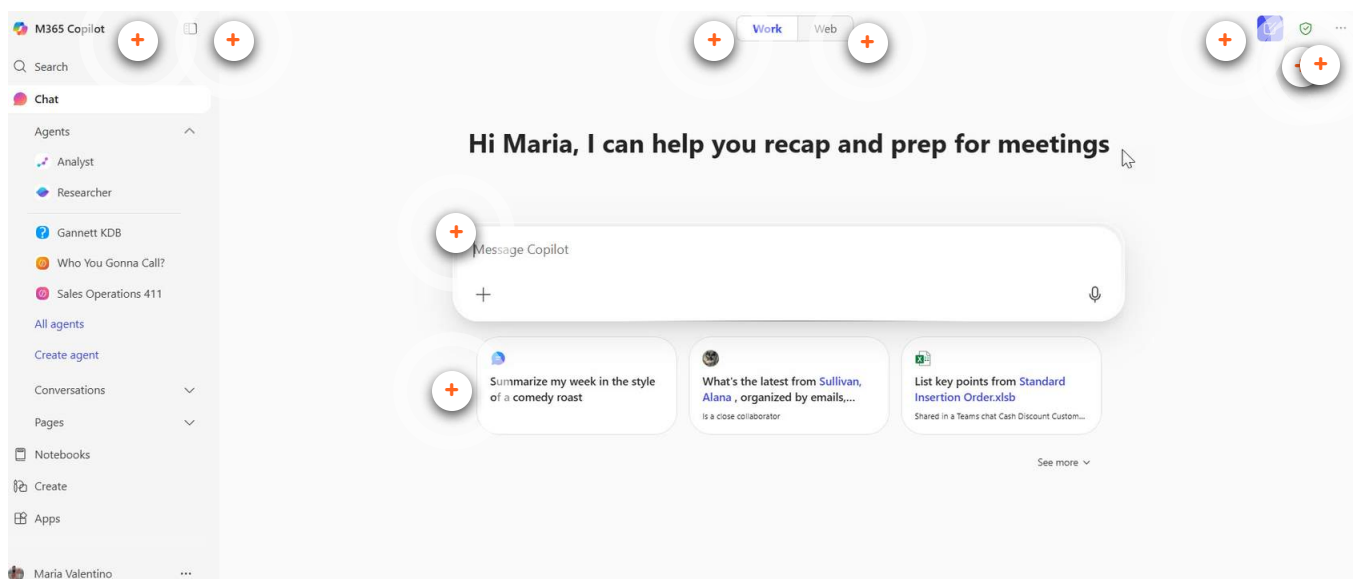
Simply, this is giving a request to Copilot to complete a task.

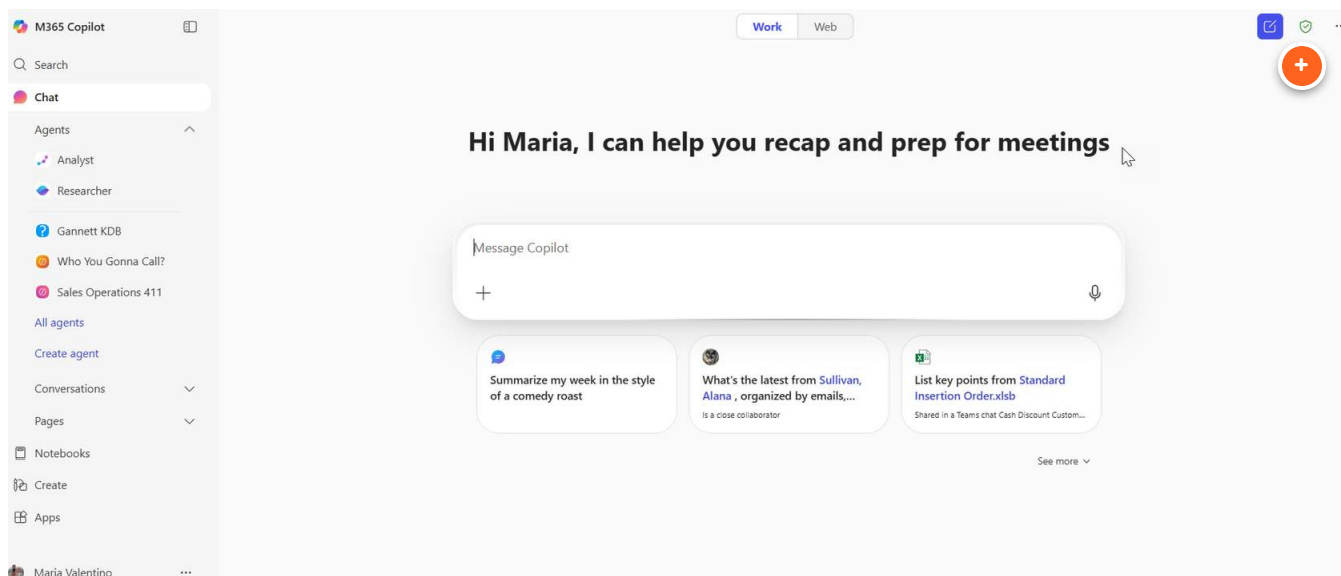
Agent

Agents are a grouping of prompts. If there is a task that you do over and over, an agent can be created. An agent is a pre-written set of instructions using prompts. An agent can be used instead of running the individual prompts.

Managing the Main Copilot Screen

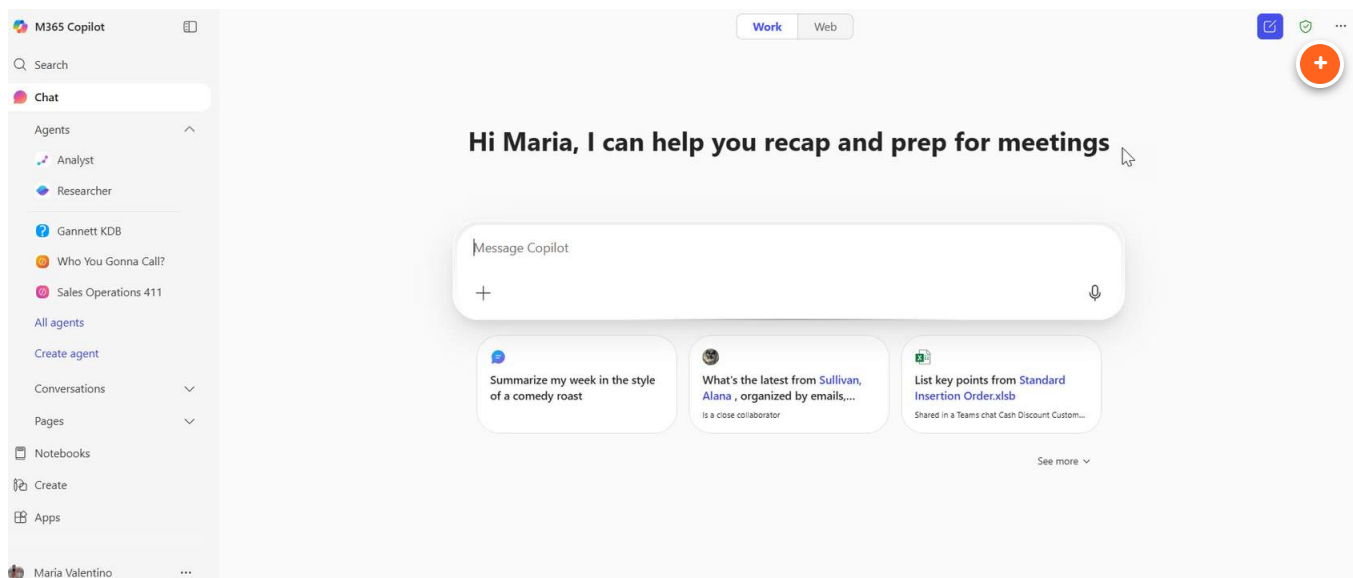
Let's look at some key elements of the main Microsoft Copilot screen. Click on the elements below to reveal new knowledge! Note, if you have the web version of Copilot, you might not see all elements below.





Enterprise Data Protection

This indicates that Enterprise Data Protection is applying to the chat. The data is secure, encrypted, private and not being used to train AI models.

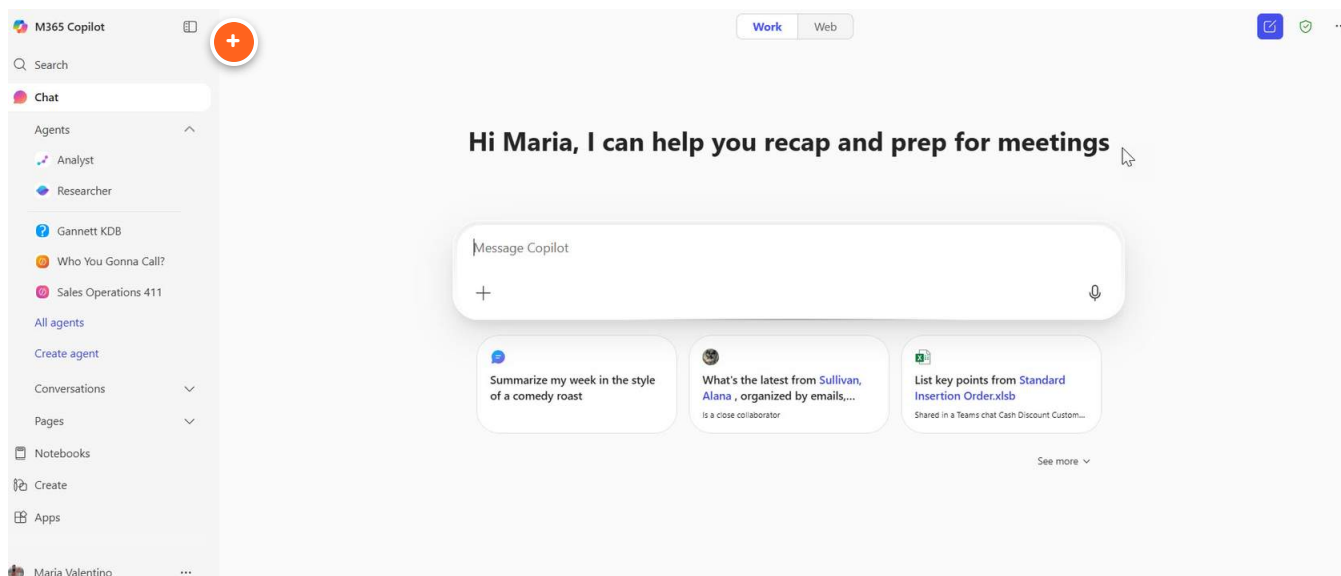


Settings Menu (Elipse)

There are further settings available under this menu.

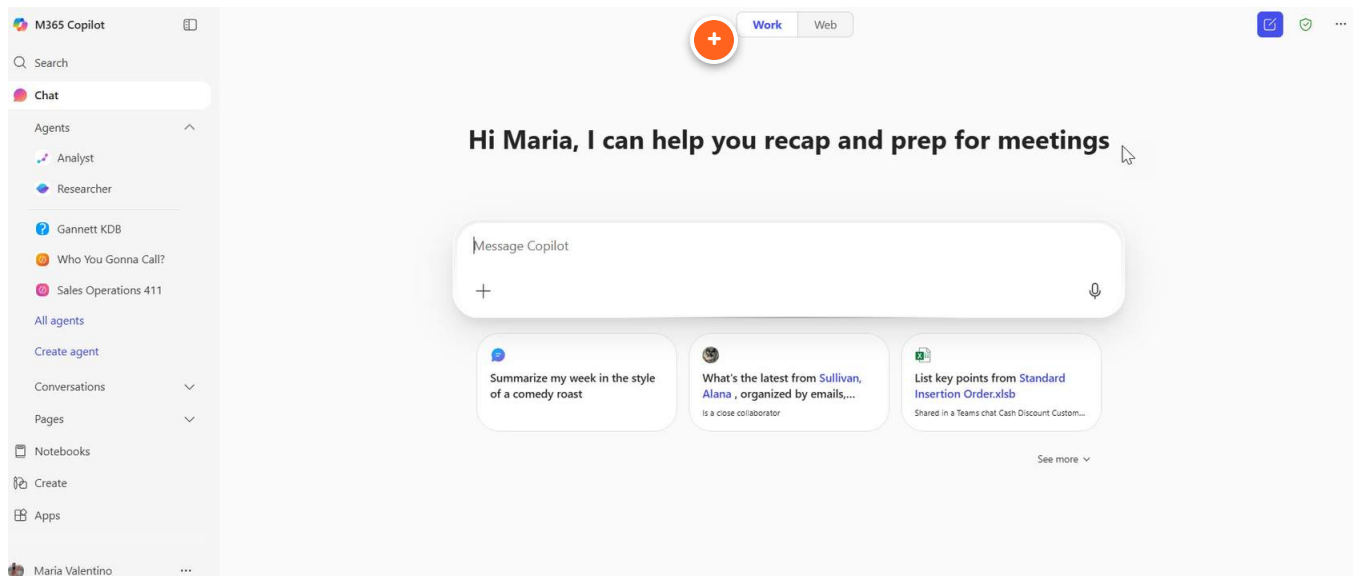
If you have the full licensed version of Copilot, a key item under this menu is the "Copilot Response Includes Web Search" slider.

Turning this on includes web search items when using the Work tab. Turning this off will limit results to only work items within the Gannett Microsoft realm.



Toggle of Microsoft Copilot Menu

This icon allows you to toggle the Microsoft Copilot menu. It can be left open or closed.



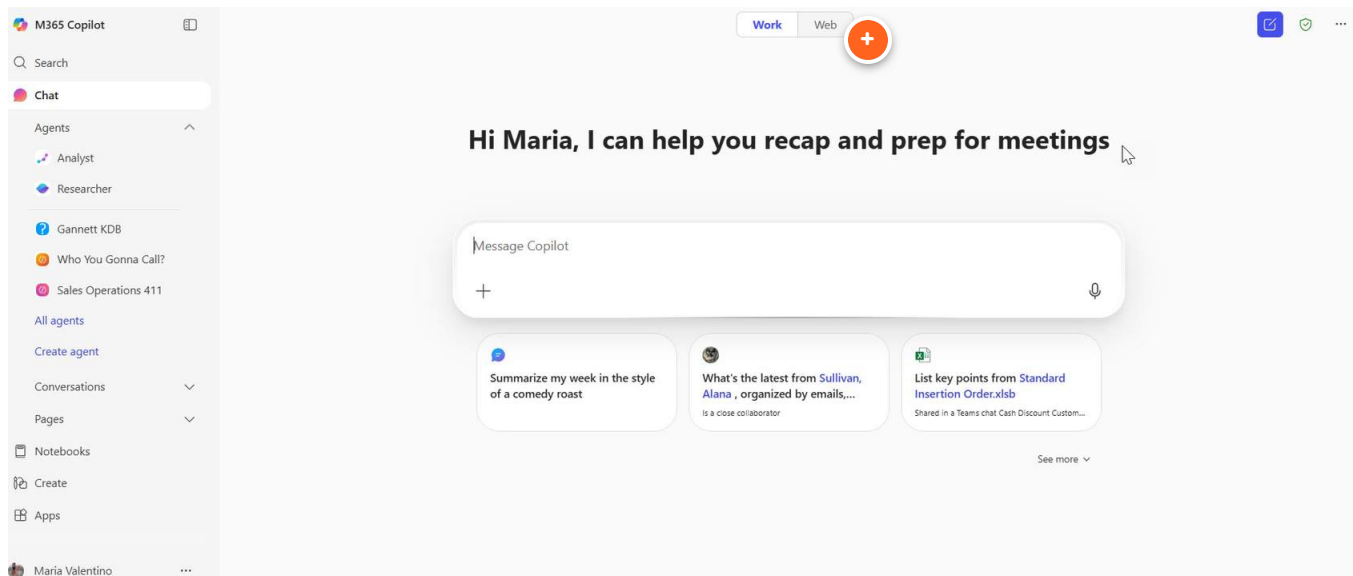
Work Toggle

This is only available if you have the full licensed version of Copilot. Prompts will utilize work data. Note, currently, work data only typically includes data in the Microsoft tools and applications. There are a few other systems (such as HR Zendesk) that has been included as well.

Note, the Work tab will only include Microsoft resources that you personally have access to view.

You can control whether the Work toggle also includes web search results by going to the Settings menu (the elipse) and turning on/off the slider that reads, "Copilot Response Includes Web Search."

The Work tab slightly prioritizes work data over web data when the web search slider is turned on.

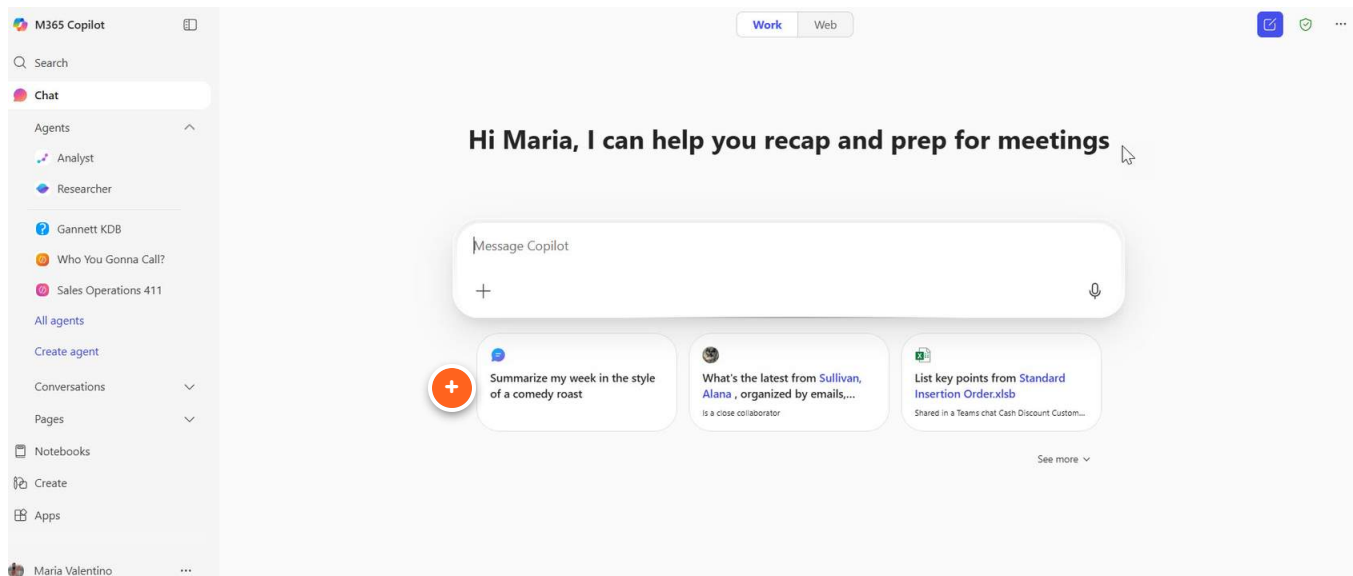


Web Toggle

If you have the web version of Copilot, this is the only tab that shows. This is an internet only search. This uses Microsoft search engines behind the scenes to pull data.

If you have the full licensed version, you will see both the Web and Work tabs, allowing you to decide which realm to work within. For example, you might not want to plan your entire vacation using the Work tab! :)

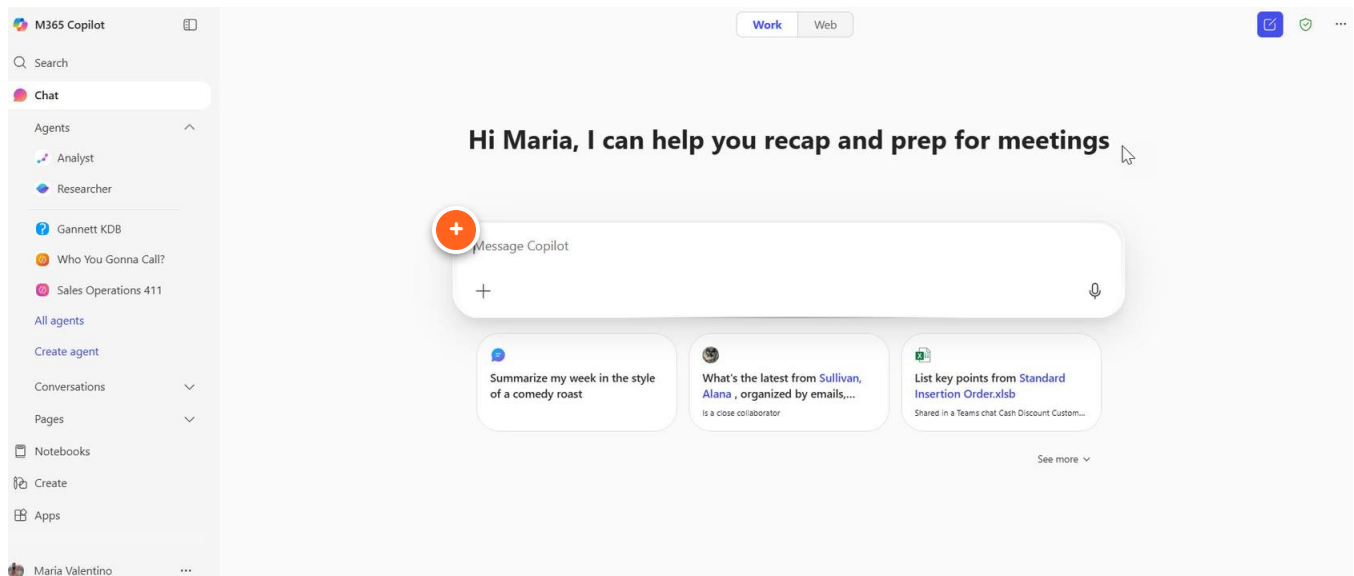
Note, the Web tab is still Enterprise Data Protected (click on the marker by the green check to learn more).



Prompt Suggestions

This area provides suggestions of prompts, based on your recent work tasks (if you have the full licensed version) or recent searches (if you have the web version).

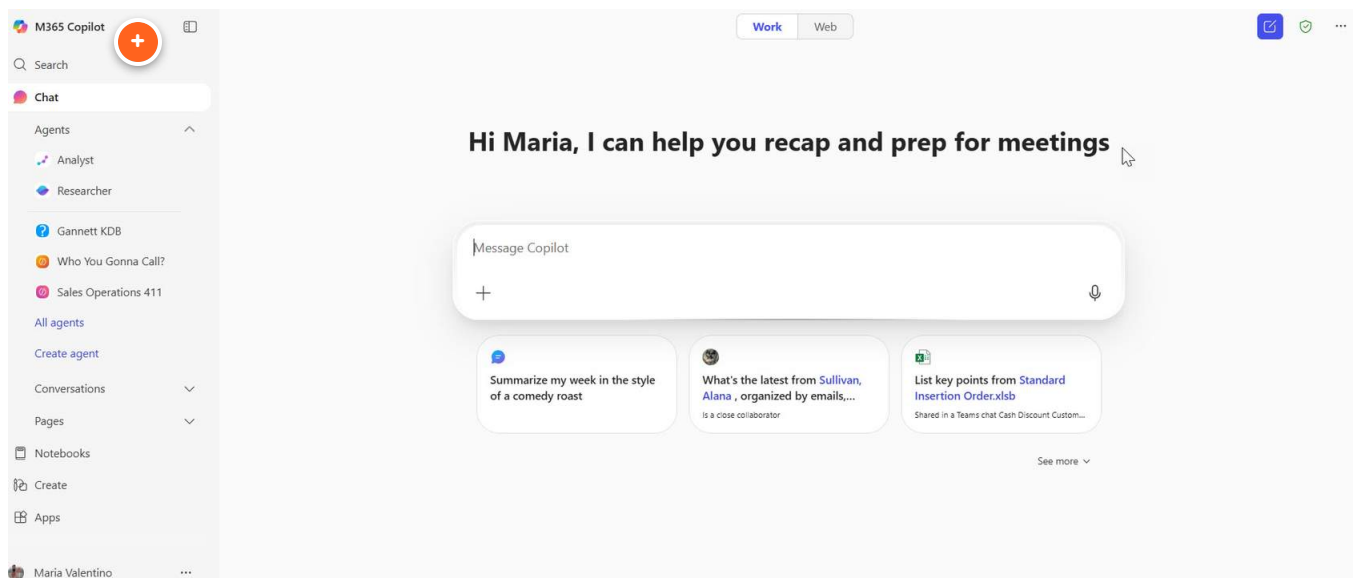
Once you are interacting with Copilot with prompts, it will also provide additional suggestions of how to change or improve your prompt.



Prompt Area

This allows you to enter a prompt, requesting Copilot accomplish a task.

This area displays when selecting the Chat item on the Copilot menu.

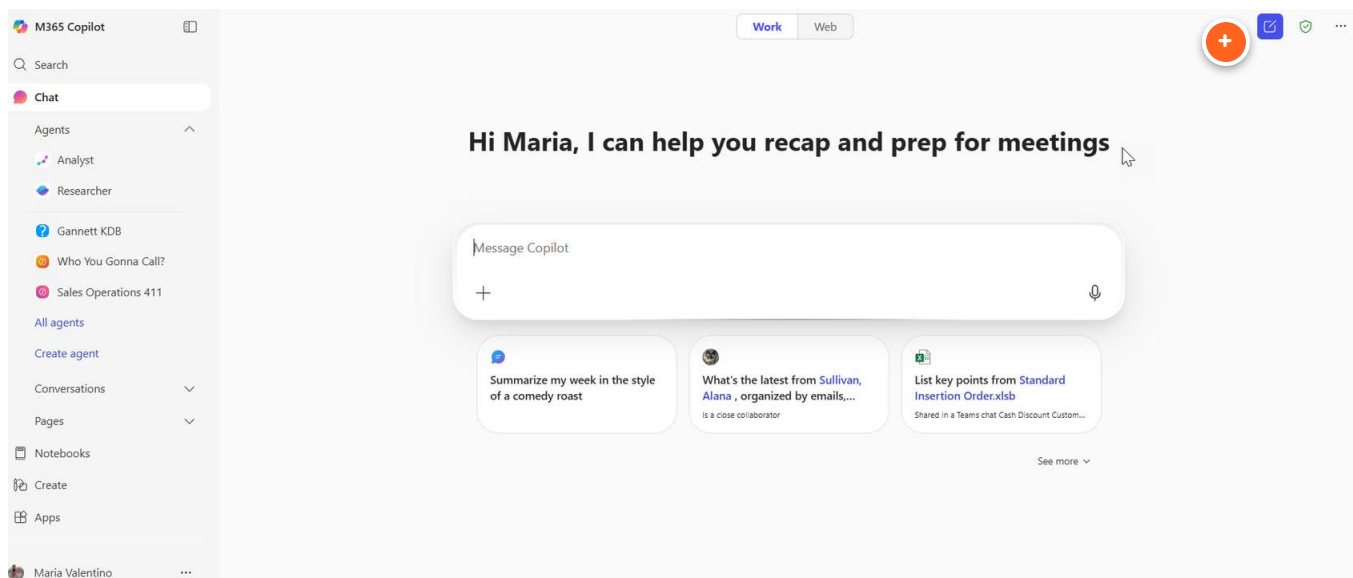


Microsoft Copilot Menu

This is the Copilot menu. Here's some definitions of key items on the menu:

- **Search:** This allows you to conduct a quick search. If you have the full licensed version, it will allow you to search across your Microsoft work items (emails, files, etc.). If you have the web version, it will allow you to search the internet only.
- **Chat:** This takes you to the main chat screen where you can enter a prompt.
- **Agents:** This shows agents you have created. It allows you to create agents. It also shows all agents available. In addition, it highlights two new built-in agents:
 - **Analyst:** This agent helps you make sense of complex data. For example, it can help you analyze and compare multiple spreadsheets, etc.
 - **Researcher:** It will take a deeper dive into information. It provides more complex details based on sources provided. Note, Researcher can take 5-30 minutes to run, so don't get impatient. We don't want to get AI angry at us--too many SCI-FI movies are based on that topic!
- **Conversations:** This shows prior chats or conversations you have had with Microsoft Copilot. You can go back to your history and get access to prior chats.
- **Pages/Notebook:** This is an area in Copilot that allows you to save and work with your AI generated content. It's like a One Note notebook.
- **Create:** This leads you through the creation of an image, a document, video, etc.

- **Apps:** This provides access to your Microsoft My Apps application chiclets.



Start a New Chat

This allows you to start a new conversation with Microsoft Copilot. Until you click on this button, Copilot will continue to reference prior conversations/prompts.

This is like saying to someone in the middle of a conversation, "On another topic, I have this question."

CONTINUE

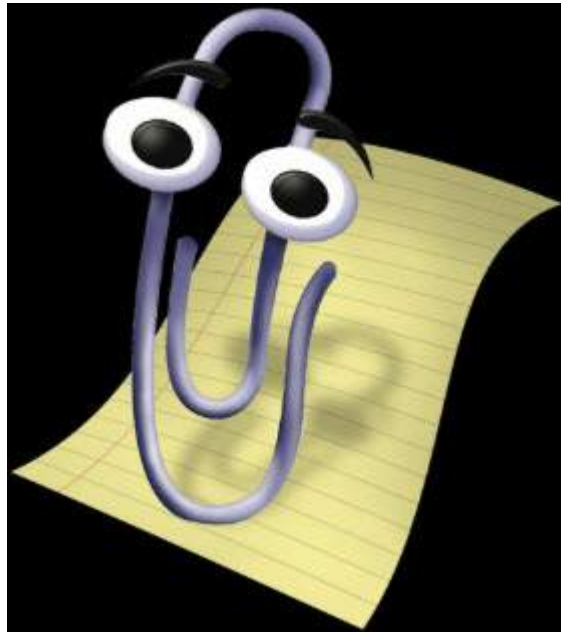
Let's Take Another Tour (not 3 hour!): Microsoft Copilot within Applications



Copilot is Everywhere

(but not in a creepy "I'm Watching You" way!)

If you have the full licensed version of Microsoft Copilot, Copilot is fully integrated into your applications. It will prompt you and provide ways to help with tasks you are working on within the Microsoft tools.



A Modern "Clippy"

Some of you may fondly remember "Clippy," an early version of a virtual assistant from Microsoft. If you don't recall this, consider yourself youthful! Clippy existed in the 1990s.

As you were doing a task, Clippy would pop up and happily offer to help. Think of Microsoft Copilot as Clippy's much more evolved grandchild!

Common Integrations

Click on the tabs to see examples of the Copilot integration within typical Microsoft applications. It might not be as cute as Clippy, but it's much more powerful!

Look for the Copilot icon or symbol in your Microsoft applications to unleash the power.

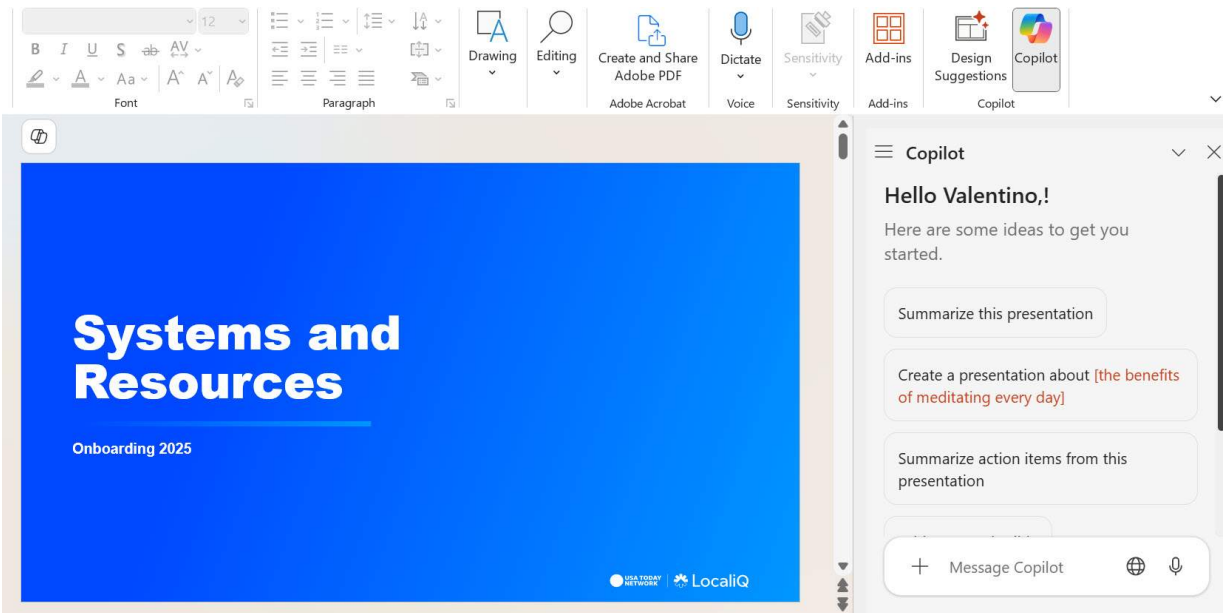
POWERPOINT

WORD

EXCEL

SHAREPOINT

Copilot is integrated with PowerPoint. If you have a presentation open, it will provide suggestions for working with it. If you have a blank screen up, it will help you create a new presentation.



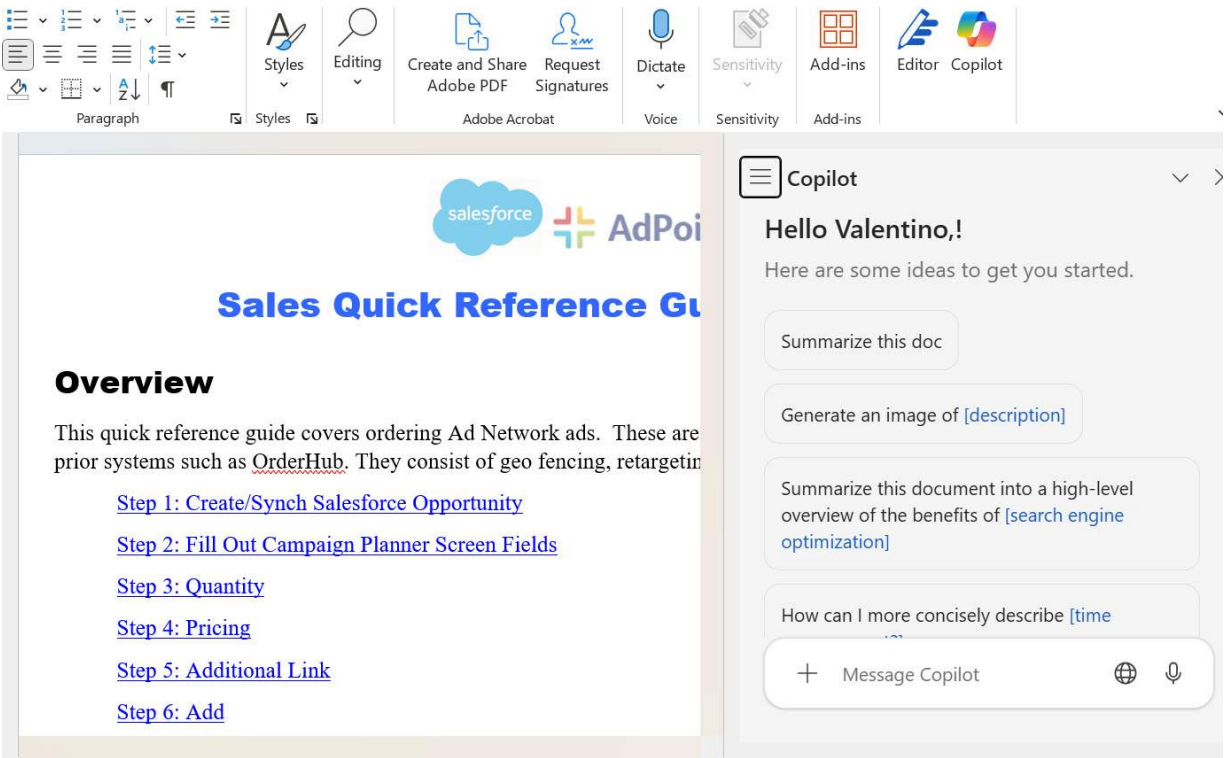
POWERPOINT

WORD

EXCEL

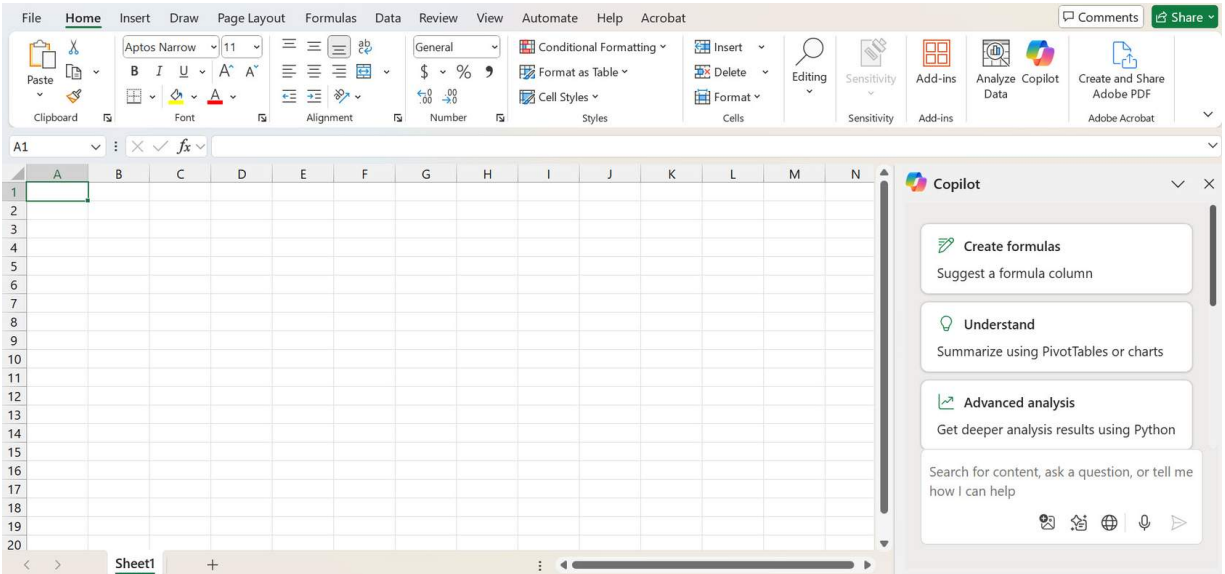
SHAREPOINT

Copilot is integrated with Word. Again, if you open a document, it will provide suggestions related to working with that particular document. If you have a blank document open, it will help you create a new document.



POWERPOINT	WORD	EXCEL	SHAREPOINT
------------	------	-------	------------

Copilot is integrated with Excel. Again, if you have a spreadsheet open, it will provide suggestions for analyzing or updating the spreadsheet. If you have a blank spreadsheet open, it will help you create a new one.



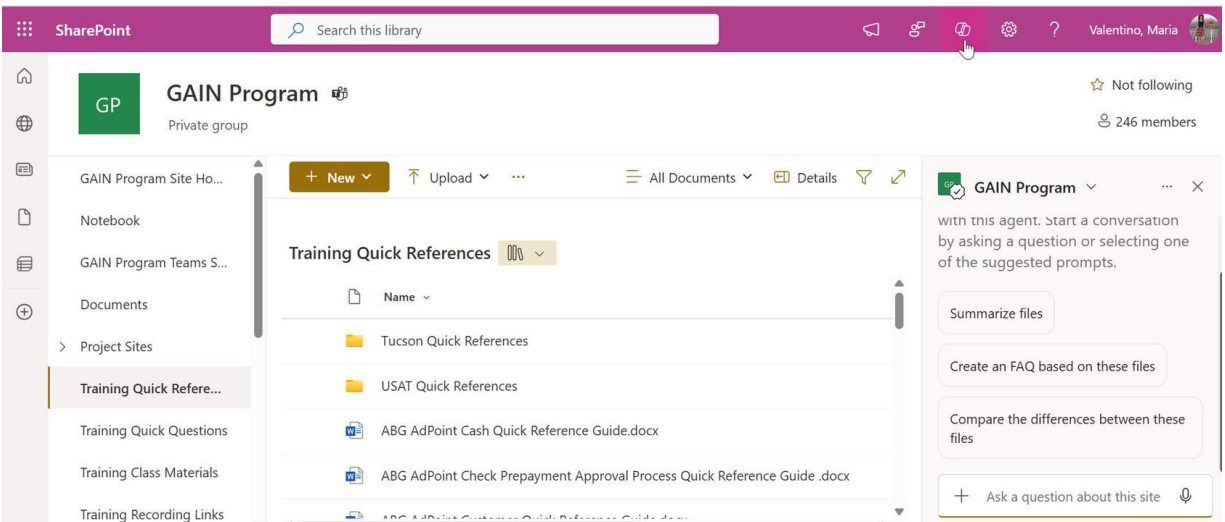
POWERPOINT

WORD

EXCEL

SHAREPOINT

Copilot is integrated with SharePoint. It can help you analyze or find files, etc.



CONTINUE

Prompt Prowess: Basics of Prompts



Reminder: Prompt Definition

We know we've been giving you a lot of information so far. A few pieces may have slipped out of your mind. Since this whole section is about prompts, let's remind you what a prompt is in Microsoft Copilot.



Prompt

Simply, a prompt is just giving a request to Copilot to complete a task.

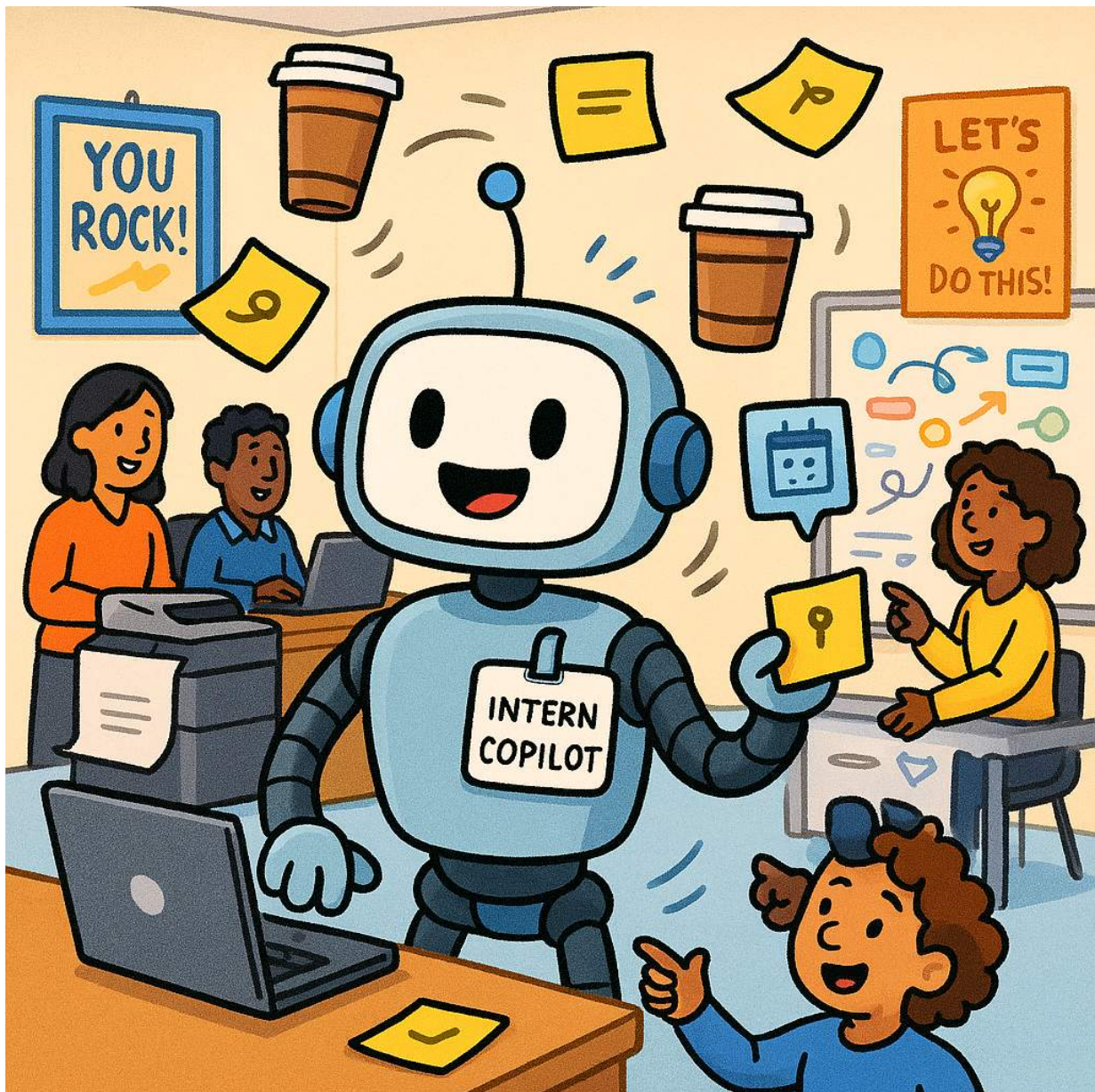
A prompt can be a:

- **Question:** "Is it time for me to take a vacation?"
- **Command:** "Plan me a trip to Italy!"
- **Description:** "Provide details of where to find the best cappuccino. Describe how it tastes, looks, smells." I need my caffeine hit right now.

Meet Microsoft Copilot, Your New Intern

Think of Microsoft Copilot as a new eager intern who has just started on your team.

Speak to it like someone who wants to help, but is green. He/she doesn't know everything about your organization yet and can get confused easily, providing incorrect or incomplete information.



Key Ingredients for Getting the Best Results from a Prompt

Flip the cards below to learn how to craft prompts to get the best results. In other words, how to best speak to your intern to not only get some coffee, but to get the work you need performed as well!

Together, these ingredients spell "GCSE"= Goal, Context, Source, Expectations. This is your cheat code for prompt writing.



Goal

What do you want the response to include? Be specific.

If you are vague with interns, you will only get their interpretation of what you want.



Context

Why do you need the information and **who** is involved?

The audience of a prompt is key.

Creating something for senior



Source

Which references and information should be used by Copilot?

These references can be internal (if you have the full licensed version of Copilot), external or both.



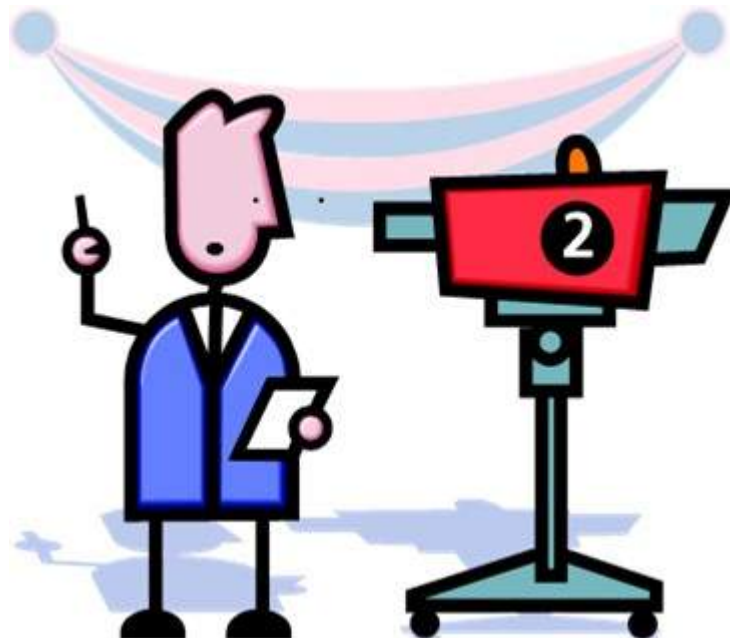
Expectations

How should Copilot respond to meet your expectations?

As we said, think of it as an intern eager to please. What will make you high five your intern and bring HER the coffee?

CONTINUE

Prompt Prowess: Let's See it Live!



Let's Stop Talking and Start Doing!

The best way to learn about prompts is to start entering them.

[Insert Real World Example Here]

To start creating a prompt, think about a real world problem you want to solve in your worklife. What would make your life easier? What would save time that you can use for other more complex tasks? What would help you out?

In this example, we will follow a salesperson using the full licensed version of Copilot. This salesperson has been having issues getting people to respond to initial contacts. She's looking for new, interesting ways to approach her leads. In sales terms, she needs new "door openers" that will get responses. She wants people to call her back!

Cheat Sheet!

Below is a template that can be downloaded help you organize your prompt creation using the GCSE ingredients discussed earlier in this class.



GCSE Template.pptx

1.1 MB



Follow the Example Below

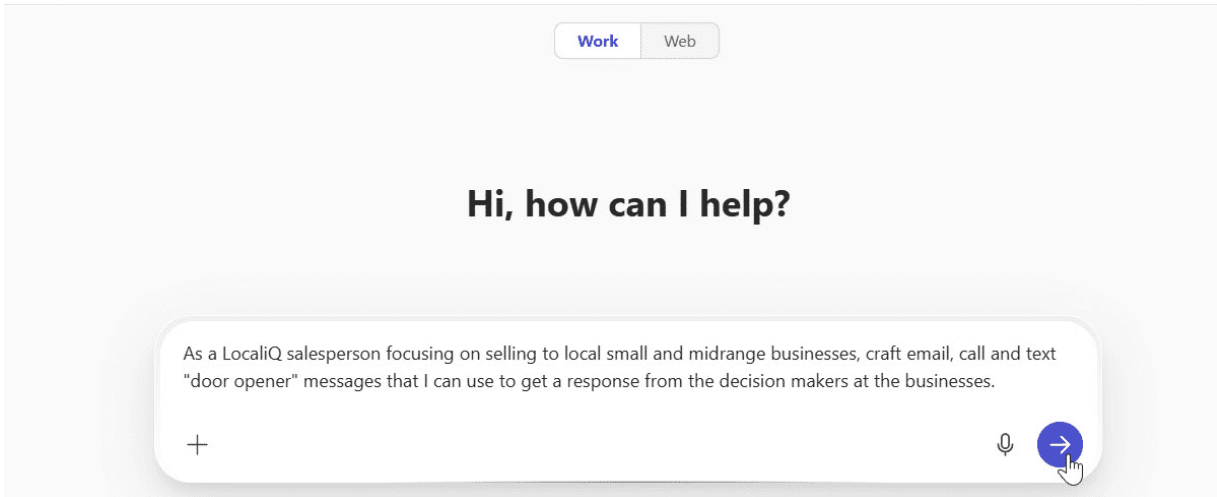
Prospect Prompting



Click the arrows to follow the steps of prompt creation used by a salesperson asking Copilot to help with prospecting.

Step 1

Initial Prompt



Initially, a general prompt was entered. It was not specific to any certain advertiser or account. Note, since we have the full licensed version of Copilot, we used the Work tab, to provide access to company information.

Goal: The creation of email, call and text "door openers."

Context: As you can see, we included who was involved (LocaliQ salesperson) along with the audience (decision makers at the business).

Source: Initially, we did not include a source. We left it general.

Expectations: These "door openers" should prompt (get it?!) a response from the decision makers.

Step 2

Initial Response



This video could not be loaded.

Because we kept the initial prompt general, the system provided a somewhat generic response to start. Copilot did provide areas where the prompt results can be customized with data it doesn't know, such as the name of the customer, etc.

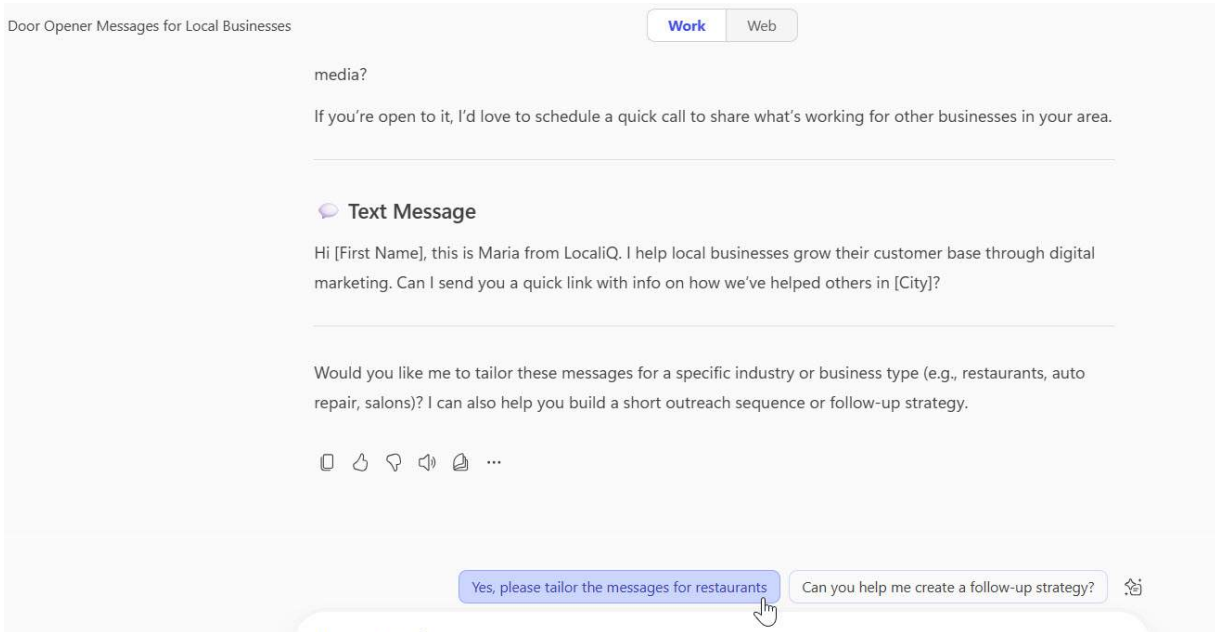
Notice how it does grab the name of the salesperson creating the prompt, her title, etc. This is because we are on the Work tab. Copilot has access to this information.

Like an eager intern, Copilot also asks further questions to help make the response better. It "prompts" you for perfection!

(Note, to view the video in a larger format, click on the fullscreen icon on the bottom right-hand side of the screen. Also, the videos in this section only provide visuals, no sound. Your computer isn't broken!)

Step 3

Honing the Prompt



We then selected one of the prompt suggestions, asking to customize for a specific industry.

Step 4

Specialized Results: Details In, Details Out!

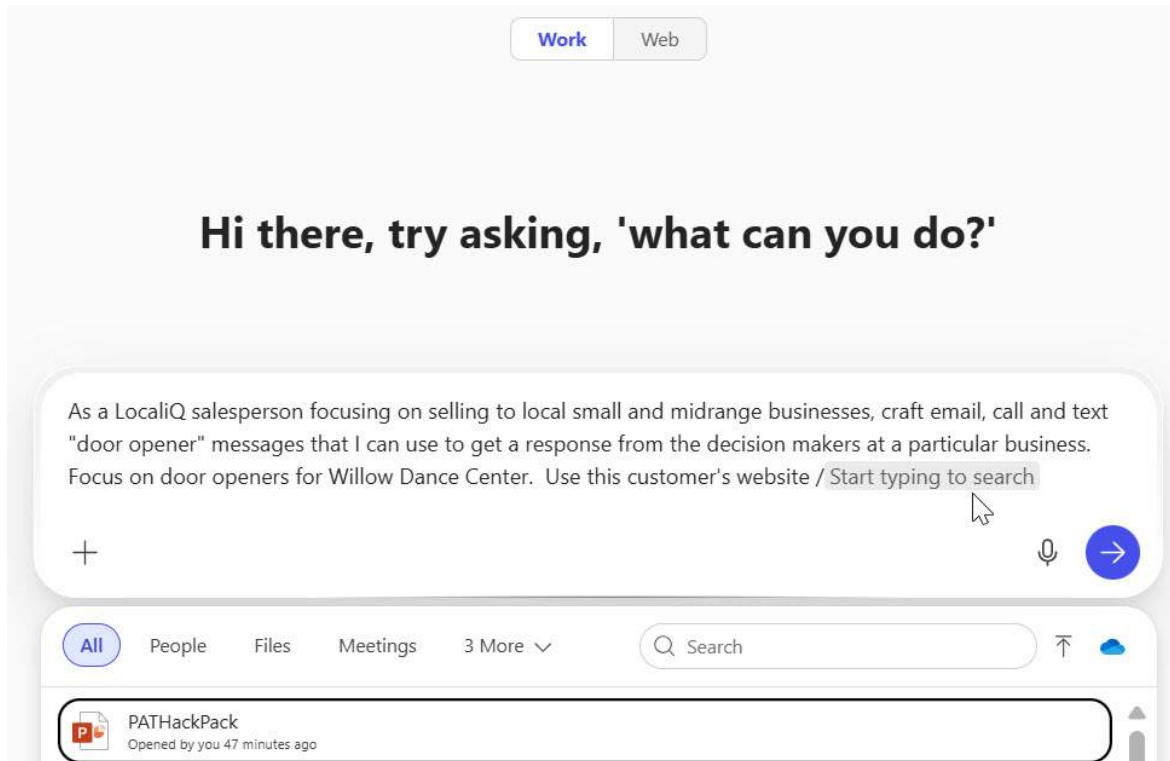


This video could not be loaded.

Because we gave Copilot more specifics (restaurant industry), it provided more detailed responses. That's the key with prompts--the more details, the better!

Step 5

Let's Get to the Source!



We can get more specialized with prompts by providing sources and specifics. We can target the prompt for a particular prospect customer by providing sources, such as their website, instagram and Facebook pages.

Note, an easy way to search for sources is to use a slash / in the prompt. As you can see above, it provides a way to search for source material. In the Work tab, it also has access to work resources. You can also just copy in links to source material.

Step 6

Much More Specialized Results!



This video could not be loaded.

Now we are getting somewhere! Get Copilot a coffee! The results are much more targeted and relate to the business.

Step 7

Hand Us a Mic and Stand In Front of a Brick Wall: Comedy Gold!

 **Text Message Door Opener**

Hi! This is Maria from LocaliQ. I love what Willow Dance Center is doing for adult dancers in Poughkeepsie. I'd love to share a few ideas to help you attract more students. Can we set up a quick call this week?

Would you like me to tailor these messages further for a specific campaign, class type, or seasonal promotion?

Sources ▾

     ...



Depending on the prospect, some humor might be in order. Copilot can deliver that as well.

While you are within the same Copilot session, you can build on prior results. We were able to ask Copilot to use the prompt from above, but make the messages funny.

Step 8

Copilot Comedy



This video could not be loaded.

As you can see, Copilot delivered more lighthearted responses, using the dance theme of the business. Again, it provides additional prompts, allowing you to hone the comedy act.

Step 9

Follow Up Funny

Funny Follow-Up Email

Subject: Still Thinking About Your Studio (Not in a Weird Way)

Hi [Name],

Just popping back into your inbox like a dancer who missed their cue. I'm still thinking about Willow Dance Center and how we could help you reach more adults who are ready to dance—but haven't found the right studio (until now).

Let's hop on a quick call this week? I'll bring the ideas—you bring the rhythm.

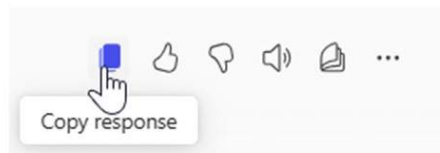
Best,

[Your Name]

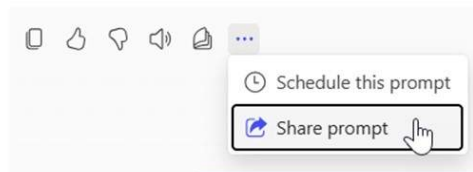
We were even able to ask Copilot to give us a funny follow up email in case the decision makers managed to resist our initial creative messages.

Step 10

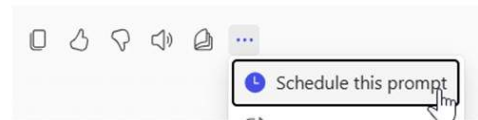
Feedback and More



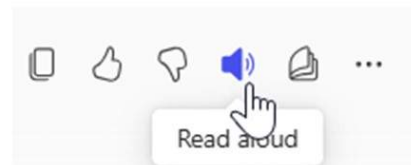
This allows you to copy the response to put it in other documents, etc.



This allows you to excitedly share the prompt with your coworkers.



This allows you to schedule the prompt, if it is something you will use all the time

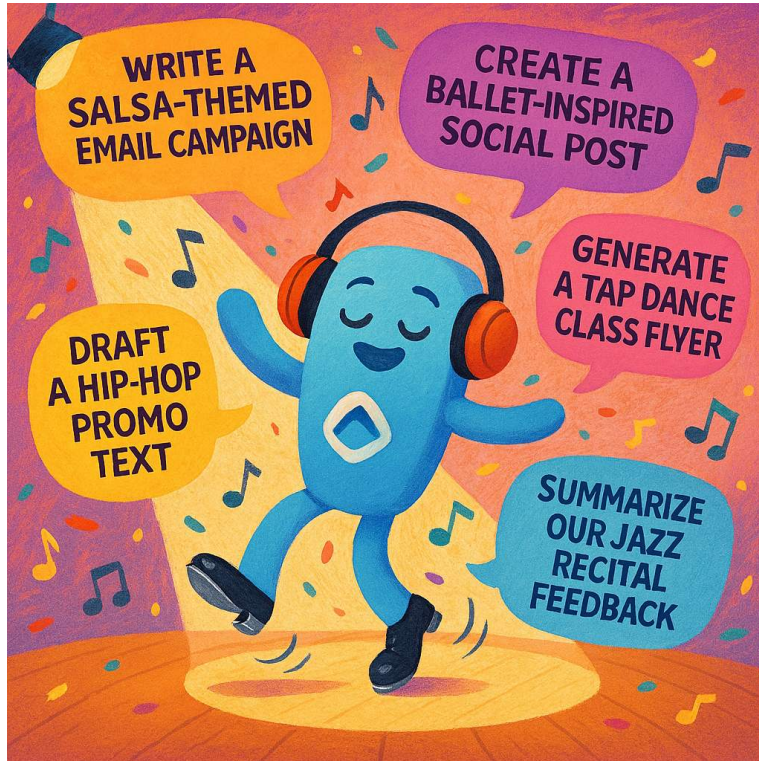


This reads the response out loud in a Sci-Fi AI voice.

Just like an intern, you can provide feedback to Copilot using the icons at the bottom of the prompts. You can provide a thumbs up or thumbs down.

There are also some other icons that are useful. Explore above.

Prompt Peeks



This is just a very quick peek into the power of prompts. As you can see, you have endless ways of slicing and dicing your responses. The best advice is to play with the prompts, learning how to get the best results for you.

CONTINUE

Prompt Prowess: Best Practices



Check Off These Prompt Best Practices



Keep it Simple: Talk to Copilot in a conversational way. Talk to it like an intern. Don't assume knowledge -- anticipate questions.



Be Specific: Do not be vague. Be very direct and actionable. Provide EXACTLY what you want.



Avoid Complexity: Do not try to do too much in one prompt. Just like a new intern, it will become overwhelmed with too many tasks at once. There should be no crying in prompting! Don't stress out Copilot. Break complex tasks into smaller prompts. Consider using an agent to link together several prompts for a repeatable command.



Understand Limits: Be aware of Copilot's limits. It can't do everything. Anything it provides needs to be checked. It can "hallucinate" incorrect information. It's a helper only. Do not rely on it blindly. Would you have your intern entirely write your senior management quarterly report for you?



Be Polite: This treads into SCI-FI territory a bit. If you are polite in your tone, Copilot will be polite back. If you are short in your tone, Copilot will respond in kind. Hey, when the machines take over the world, it will be better to be known as someone who was kind to them, right!? (Just kidding!)



Schedule: Use scheduled prompts for repeatable tasks. Remember, there is a scheduling option under the ellipses at the end of a prompt response.



Test and Refine: Continually update prompts based on results. Don't just accept the first answer and give up if it's not what you want. Would you fire your intern if he failed at one initial task?



Sharing is Caring: Share prompts you create with your coworkers, your managers, your team. The more knowledge that is shared within the company, the better!

CONTINUE

Check Yourself! Knowledge Check



Prompt Perception

Here's some questions for you to test yourself for prompting purposes.

Knowledge Check

What are the key ingredients in building a prompt? Check all that apply.

☐ Expectations

☐ Performance

☐ Source

☐ Goal

☐

Context

☐

Testing

SUBMIT

Which is the best example of a prompt?

☐

Provide me with a list of prospects in my area.

☐

I need leads NOW!

☐

As a local salesperson, please provide me with a list of prospects in the home improvement business. They need to be located within 100 miles of Poughkeepsie, NY. Do not include prospects already on this lead list found at www.leadsrus.com.

SUBMIT

Match the definitions of these two types of agents available to use in Copilot.



Researcher

This agent helps you get more details about a subject or group of sources of information.



Analyst

This agent helps you make sense of complicated data.

SUBMIT

CONTINUE

Tell Me More: References



Yes, We Know You Could Just Ask Copilot to Find These Resources!

While Copilot could find these resources for you, we will go "old school" and list them out as well. Explore these resources below to learn more.

Also, "fun fact" -- most of the images in this training class were created by Copilot.

- **Microsoft Copilot Community:** Join the Gannett Microsoft Copilot Community here: [Copilot Community](#)
- **Resources:** There are job aids available in this post: [Resources](#)
- **Training Curriculums:** Here are some further training curriculums/classes to explore for more details:
 - [AI Explorer for M365 Copilot Curriculum](#)
 - [AI Explorer: Navigating the Basics](#)
- **Requesting Access:** Here are the ways to request different levels of access to Copilot.
 - **Web Access:** To request access to the basic web version of Copilot, follow the steps in this document: [Copilot Web Access](#). If you don't have access to Sales Essentials, reach out to salesprocesshelp@gannett.com and we can provide the instructions.
 - **Full Licensed Version:** To request access to the full licensed version of Copilot, fill out the Service Desk form here: [Copilot Licensed Access](#)